Read accessible description

“We experienced eight years of denial, but that’s not unusual in environmental issues.”

Gene Likens

Emission control

In the 1970s and 1980s, other areas badly affected by acid rain included the “Black Triangle” of Czechoslovakia, Germany, and Poland, where large areas of forest died. Thanks to Likens’s work, stricter controls were brought in after 1990. Scrubber systems that extract SO_2 were fitted to power station chimneys with great success. Emissions of the gas were cut by almost half in the US, and by two thirds in Europe. Fish began to return to lakes and rivers. However, the problem of acid rain still blights parts of Russia, China, and India.